secular while Hindutva is not; Hinduism is a positive while Hindutva is negative. The RSS, of course, rejects such a distinction between the two concepts and these positions.

What the RSS Understands by the Term 'Hindu Rashtra'

What does this mean for those who believe that the RSS will impose upon India a Hindu Rashtra? The RSS says it does not need to, because India is already a Hindu Rashtra.[29] This needs some explanation. Hindutva, for the RSS, is not only Hinduism, but the very essence of Indianness. As Mohan Bhagwat made clear in a series of public lectures in Delhi in 2018: 'We refer to Hindutva as a value system. There are those who prefer to call it "Indic", others call it "Bharatiya"—we accept all these terminologies as the same … What is called as Hinduism today is not the same as the religion of the Hindus. There exists no specific Hindu "*shastra*" because they were composed before the word Hindu became prevalent. Our ancient scriptures are meant for everyone, not limited to a few … Bharat is not merely a geographic term … Bharat is explained by the word Hindu. Hence Sangh is insistent on the word Hindu.'[30] In this view, India has long been a Hindu Rashtra. As Bhagwat put it, 'Hindutva is essentially all-inclusive. It will be the basis of a strong and prosperous Bharat … Living life with this discipline is Hindutva. It is the collective wisdom of all the sects originating out of India. That is why we say that ours is a Hindu Rashtra.'[31]

This opinion is a core belief in an organisation where every member swears allegiance to the Bhagwa Dhwaj and considers it his 'Guru'. It also explains why *Organiser* often publishes articles on the theme of Hindu Rashtra. A typical piece, in 2018, for example, on Hindutva and the concept of Hindu Rashtra, argued that to 'all the people, who regularly say, that a Hindu Rashtra will be declared soon—sorry. Bharat is a Hindu Rashtra and all its citizens are Hindus, irrespective of their mode of worship. It will remain so until there is a single Hindu by birth or belief in this geography. All that is necessary is the awareness within everyone that this is a Hindu